

AN INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PROGRAMME · 2026

UNIFIED MECHANICS

A World of Distinctions

The Corpus — a reader's guide to the complete edition

JOSEPH SHIELDS

JULY 2026

THE GOVERNING SENTENCE

*“A realised system retains identity through distinctions,
responds to local conditions through admissible processes, and
describes those processes by the records they leave.”*

— the sentence every volume of this corpus writes twice: once in physics, once in mathematics

WHAT THIS CORPUS IS

Unified Mechanics is an independent research programme exploring whether many familiar structures in mathematics and physics can be understood through one shared systems-level framework. The programme distinguishes between the abstract rules used to describe systems, the physical systems that realise those rules, the local conditions that shape their behaviour, and the records through which those systems become observable.

The framework does not claim that mathematics alone creates a universe from nothing. Its aim is to describe how real systems retain identity, interact with their surroundings, transform over time, and leave measurable records. The corpus gathers that account into seven volumes, each with one job, ordered so that the physical picture always precedes the formal compression that tests it.

THE CORPUS MAP

Vol.	Title	What it does	Role
00	The Corpus Guide	This volume. Orientation, reading order, and the claim-grade contract.	GUIDE
01	A World of Distinctions — Main Monograph	The complete physical and mathematical reconstruction in six parts: the physical source model, the internal mathematical reconstruction, Primordial Loop Algebra, physical realisation, cosmos-quanta-matter-life, and tests, solvers, and governance.	FOUNDATION
02	The Compact Monograph	The same architecture compressed for fast reading and review. It introduces no independent theory; where detail is omitted, the Main Monograph governs.	COMPRESSION
03	Universopedia — Formal Complete Edition	The observational language standard and cross-scale physical ledger. Mechanism before measurement; the class dictionary; the periodic table as the first complete language family; the cross-scale object atlas; the Familiarity Kernel.	OBSERVATION
04	The Realisation and Self-Description Principle	The closing mathematical principle: why the ontology does nothing by itself, and how a realised system becomes physically describable through the records it leaves.	CLOSURE
05	The Snowflake Realisation Closure Theorem	The observer-readout closure: from the 240-root residual through the A_2 snowflake carrier, an exact forty-cell cover, codimension-one realisation, and the Gauss–Bonnet readout to a constant vacuum term.	READOUT
06	The Semantic Word System	From sentences to the fixed-point axiom: a typed compression language in which ordinary statements are compressed without losing the distinctions that gave them meaning.	LANGUAGE

HOW TO READ IT

A useful first pass takes the volumes in numbered order: the Main Monograph establishes the full architecture; the Compact Monograph fixes it in memory; Universopedia grounds it in observed systems; the Realisation Principle closes the ontology; the Snowflake Theorem closes the observer readout; and the Semantic Word System shows the language operating at sentence level.

A fast pass reads Volume 02 first, then Volume 05 for the sharpest single result, returning to Volume 01 wherever the compressed statements demand their full derivation.

THE CLAIM-GRADE CONTRACT

Every volume keeps five kinds of statement in one chain but never treats them as interchangeable. Observed data and executed computations are reported as records rather than elevated to a sixth grade: they can support or falsify a proposed realisation, but they do not change the truth of an internal theorem.

PROVED	Follows inside the stated mathematical definitions and assumptions.
CONDITIONAL	Follows once an explicitly named representation or physical realisation condition is accepted.
CONJECTURED	A precise extension suggested by the framework but not yet closed by proof or decisive test.
PROPOSED	A concrete physical model or constitutive law offered for direct calculation and falsification.
POSTULATE	A primitive physical or semantic commitment used to connect the internal mathematics to realised systems.

CORRECTION PROTOCOL

The corpus is intended to be inspectable, testable, and open to correction. The most useful feedback concerns mathematical gaps, hidden assumptions, unclear definitions, circular reasoning, conflicts with established results, related mathematical work, and ways to make the framework more precise.